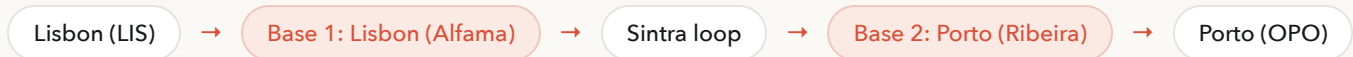


Lisbon, Sintra & Porto

A one-way run up Portugal, from the Tagus to the Douro. Fly into Lisbon, soak up Sintra and the Atlantic edge, then relocate north to Porto and the port cellars of Gaia, no backtrack required.

Sep 10 to 14, 2026 · 4 travelers · one rental SUV



Two bases, one direction. You sleep two nights in central Lisbon (Thu, Fri), then relocate north on Saturday for two nights in Porto (Sat, Sun). The relocation is the point: flying into LIS and out of OPO means Porto cannot be a day trip. A round trip from Lisbon would cost roughly 6 to 7 hours of driving (about 310 km each way), and your departure airport sits on the wrong end. Moving the base north on Saturday turns that into a single A1 leg of about 3 to 3.5 hours, with room for one mid route stop. Keep the SUV parked in a garage in town; Alfama and Ribeira streets are too narrow and steep to drive.

01

01 THU SEP
10

Land in Lisbon, ease into Belem

Arrival day, stay central, beat the jet lag with a riverside afternoon

- 11:00a

Land at Lisbon Airport (LIS). Clear customs, taxi or Uber into [Alfama](#), drop bags at the hotel. Do not pick up the car yet; you do not need it in the old town.
- 2:00p

Jeronimos Monastery, Belem. Manueline cloisters and Vasco da Gama's tomb. Timed entry, pre-booked. Closed Mondays, so today is the window. [Map](#) TIMED
- 4:00p

Belem Tower. The 16th century river fort, freshly reopened after restoration. Pre-booked slot, walk-ups get turned away. [Map](#) TIMED
- 5:00p

Pasteis de Belem. The original custard tarts, warm and dusted with cinnamon, two doors from the monastery. [Map](#)
- 7:00p

Dinner in Alfama. Grilled sardines and a glass of vinho verde near the cathedral, then an early night. [Map](#)

02

02 FRI SEP
11

Sintra palaces, then the Atlantic edge

Pena and Regaleira in the morning, Cabo da Roca and Cascais by afternoon, loop back to Lisbon

- 9:30a Pena Palace, Sintra.** The candy colored hilltop palace and its park. Drive from Lisbon is about 30 to 40 minutes. Early timed slot, booked weeks ahead. [Map](#) **TIMED**
- Drive: Lisbon to Pena Palace, about 29 km, roughly 30 to 40 min. [Directions](#)
- 1:00p Quinta da Regaleira.** Gothic estate with the spiral Initiation Well and mossy garden tunnels. Same day timed slot, self guided. [Map](#) **TIMED**
- 3:45p Cabo da Roca.** The westernmost point of mainland Europe, cliffs over the Atlantic, best in late afternoon light. Exposed and windy even in September, bring a layer. [Map](#)
- Drive: Sintra to Cabo da Roca, about 18 km, roughly 25 to 28 min. [Directions](#)
- 5:15p Cascais.** Easygoing beach town for a seafront stroll and an early dinner before the run back. [Map](#)
- Drive: Cabo da Roca to Cascais (about 18 km, roughly 30 min), then Cascais back to Lisbon (about 30 km, roughly 30 to 40 min). [Directions](#)

03

03 SAT SEP
12

Relocate north on the A1, one stop only

Check out of Lisbon, drive to Porto with a single mid route break, settle into Ribeira

- 9:00a Check out and leave Lisbon by 9:00.** Today is a logistics day, do not over schedule it. A1 toll is about EUR 23; the road is electronic toll, so confirm the Via Verde device.
- Drive: Lisbon to Aveiro on the A1, about 250 km, roughly 2.5 hours. [Directions](#)
- 11:45a Aveiro (the lighter stop).** Canals, candy striped moliceiro boats and a quick lunch, about 1.5 to 2 hours off the motorway. Swap for Coimbra only if you pre-booked a Joanina Library slot. [Map](#)
- Drive: Aveiro to Porto on the A1, about 75 km, roughly 50 min. [Directions](#)
- 3:30p Check in, Porto Ribeira.** Park the SUV in a pre-booked Gaia or Trindade garage and leave it there until Monday. [Map](#)
- 7:00p Evening on the Cais da Ribeira.** Sunset over the Dom Luis I bridge and dinner by the river, nothing else booked tonight. [Map](#)

04

04 SUN
SEP 13

Porto historic core and the Douro

Lello and Clerigos early, then your choice of a full Douro day or the Gaia port cellars

- 9:00a Livraria Lello.** The carved staircase bookshop, busiest 11:00 to 14:00, so go at opening. Voucher redeems against a book. [Map](#) **TIMED**
- 10:15a Clerigos Tower.** Climb the baroque tower for the rooftop view over the old town. Ticket covers tower, church and museum. [Map](#)
- 12:00p Option 1, Douro Valley day tour.** Small group, two quintas, tastings, lunch and a Rabelo cruise near Pinhao. Returns about 18:00, so it must be today, not Monday. [Map](#) **PRE-BOOKED**
- 2:00p Option 2, port cellars in Vila Nova de Gaia.** If you skip the Douro, cross the bridge for a reserved tour and tasting at Taylor's, Graham's or Sandeman. [Map](#) **PRE-BOOKED**
- 7:30p Dinner in Porto.** A francesinha and a glass of tawny back in the Baixa to close out the Porto leg. [Map](#)

Porto morning, evening flight out of OPO

A short open core morning, then return the car and fly home. Note: many museums close Mondays

- 9:30a** **Gaia riverside and a final tasting.** The port lodges stay open Mondays, so a last cellar visit or a walk along the Gaia quay works. Belem, Jeronimos and Belem Tower are closed today, which is why they sat on Day 1. [Map](#)
-
- 12:00p** **Collect the SUV and head to OPO.** Pull the car from the garage and drive out to the airport. [Map](#)
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- Drive: Ribeira to Porto Airport (OPO), about 17 km, roughly 25 to 30 min. [Directions](#)
-
- 1:30p** **Return the car, then bag drop.** Return the one way rental at OPO and clear security with a 3 hour international buffer before the evening flight. Back plan the exact departure time and work backwards from it.

Two things that cannot slip

- The one way LIS to OPO automatic SUV, with the drop fee and a Via Verde toll device confirmed. Book today: automatics and one way allocations disappear first, and the whole route depends on the car existing.
- An early Pena Palace timed slot for Fri Sep 11, paired with a same day Regaleira slot. Book now on [parquesdesintra.pt](#); without it the Sintra, Cabo da Roca and Cascais loop collapses under a roughly 3 hour walk-up queue.

Book before it sells out

- One way LIS to OPO automatic SUV: about EUR 250 to 450 for the car, plus a one way drop fee of EUR 50 to 150, Via Verde toll device about EUR 2 per day, and the A1 toll about EUR 23. Book 2 to 3 months out, so now.
- Pena Palace full ticket (park plus interior), early Fri Sep 11: EUR 20 per person on [parquesdesintra.pt](#). Morning slots go weeks ahead.
- Quinta da Regaleira, Fri Sep 11 afternoon: EUR 15 per person, self guided, on [regaleira.byblueticket.pt](#). Pair same day with Pena.
- Jeronimos plus Belem Tower timed slots, Thu Sep 10 afternoon: about EUR 18 to 20 combined. The only Belem window, since Monday is closed.
- Douro Valley small group day tour, Sun Sep 13: EUR 85 to 120 per person, 2 to 4 weeks out. Not Monday.
- Livraria Lello voucher, about 9:00 slot Sun or Mon: EUR 10 per person, redeemable against a book.

Tap any link to open the spot in Google Maps; the drive legs open turn by turn directions. Weather: mid September in Portugal is mild and dry, roughly 18 to 27 C, with cool, windy evenings on the coast and at Cabo da Roca, so pack a light layer for after dark.